

3. Recommendation Report

Reflection

EGR 3350-07

Technical Communications for Engineers and Computer Scientists

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Reflection: Selecting the Best Password Manager for College Students

The recommendation report comparing Bitwarden, 1Password, and LastPass for college student use was the most research-intensive writing assignment of the semester. Earning a score of 16 out of 16 was gratifying, and the instructor's written feedback was 'Very nicely done' and 'Well researched.' 'Good work' confirmed that the report was both technically sound and clearly presented. This reflection examines why the report succeeded and what habits I want to carry forward.

The report's greatest strength was its evidence-based structure. Each of the three evaluation criteria, security features, ease of use, and annual cost, followed an explanation data-interpretation pattern that guided the reader from context to evidence to conclusion before any recommendation was offered. This prevented the report from reading like an opinion piece and positioned the final recommendation as the logical outcome of the research. The three comparison tables reinforced this by giving readers a concise visual summary at each stage.

The selection of peer-reviewed and industry sources also contributed to the report's credibility. Drawing on IEEE conference papers about password manager usability and security, alongside official pricing pages from Bitwarden, 1Password, and LastPass, allowed me to ground every factual claim in a verifiable source. Providing six properly formatted IEEE-style references demonstrated that the research process was systematic rather than superficial.

If I were to revise this report, I would focus on one self-identified limitation: the scope was restricted to individual student plans, which meant I did not explore whether family or student-discount pricing might change the recommendation. A brief acknowledgment of this

boundary in the scope section would have made the report more transparent about the limits of its conclusions.

More broadly, this report reinforced that strong technical writing is as much about disciplined research as it is about clear prose. The process of locating credible sources, extracting relevant data, and presenting it in a form matched to the audience's needs is a skill I will continue to develop throughout my engineering career.